Ask Dave Real Estate Tools – How It Works

A complete guide to every feature

Ask Dave Real Estate Tools v1.0.0 © 2026

Ask Dave Real Estate Tools runs quietly in your system tray and helps you do everything faster – **dial**, **message on WhatsApp**, **send emails**, **take structured notes in OneNote**, **send RERA forms**, **book viewings**, **set follow-up reminders**, and **stay informed with UAE real estate news**. It works on top of whatever you already use – your CRM, your browser, Excel, emails, PDFs – anything where you can highlight text on screen.

There are two main parts to the tool:

- **The Compact Window** – a dark-themed frameless window (320×260) that appears when you highlight text and press `Ctrl+Space`
- **The Expanded Panel** – the full-size view (380×680) with contact details, templates, forms, scheduling, and news

1. Smart Text Detection

AUTOMATIC

Highlight text, get instant actions

Highlight any text on your screen, then press `Ctrl+Space`. Ask Dave Real Estate Tools intelligently extracts phone numbers, email addresses, names, and property units from whatever you highlighted. The compact window appears with the detected information ready for action.

Highlight text on screen → Press Ctrl+Space → Compact window appears → Click Dial, WhatsApp, or Expand

Where it works: Everywhere. Browsers, CRM systems (Bayut, Property Finder, HubSpot, Salesforce), Excel, Word, PDFs, emails, WhatsApp Desktop, Outlook – if you can highlight text, Ask Dave Real Estate Tools will detect the data.

Phone number detection

The app recognises phone numbers in all common formats:

Format	Example	Detected?
UAE mobile	0501234567	Yes
UAE mobile with country code	+971501234567	Yes
UAE mobile with 00 prefix	00971501234567	Yes
UAE mobile with spaces	05 012 34567	Yes
UAE landline	04 123 4567	Yes
International numbers	+44 7911 123456	Yes
Random text	"Call me tomorrow"	No (ignored)

Email detection

Standalone email addresses are also detected from your highlighted text. When an email is found, it automatically enables the Gmail compose option in the expanded panel.

Block text extraction

You don't need to carefully select just a phone number. Highlight an entire CRM record, email signature, or contact card – the app will pull out **all the fields** automatically: phone number, email address, name, and property unit. Labels like "Full Name:", "Email:", "Property Interest:", and "Unit 1204, Marina Heights Tower" are all understood.

> **Smart number handling:** Ask Dave Real Estate Tools automatically normalises every number to international format. Whether you highlight "0501234567" or "00971501234567" or "+971 50 123 4567", it all becomes the same clean number.

2. The Compact Window

COMPACT WINDOW

Your quick-action starting point

When you highlight text and press `Ctrl+Space`, the compact window appears. It is a dark-themed frameless window (320×260) with a custom title bar and the following elements:

Element	What it does
Phone number row	Displays the detected phone number with a UAE flag icon. You can also edit the number directly.
Dial button	Sends the number to your phone's dialler via Microsoft Phone Link. The number is pre-filled – you press the call button yourself.
WhatsApp button	Opens a WhatsApp conversation with the detected number. Choose a template or start a blank chat.
Expand link	Opens the full expanded panel (380×680) with all features: contact card, templates, forms, scheduling, and more.

Highlight text → Press Ctrl+Space → Compact window shows detected number → Click Dial, WhatsApp, or Expand

> **Tip:** The compact window stays out of your way at 320×260 pixels. For quick calls and WhatsApp messages, you never need to open the full panel – just highlight, press `Ctrl+Space`, and click.

3. Click-to-Dial & Phone Link

COMPACT WINDOW

How the Dial button works

When you click **Dial** in the compact window or the expanded panel, Ask Dave Real Estate Tools sends the phone number to your phone's dialler via **Microsoft Phone Link**. The number is pre-filled and ready – you still press the green call button yourself. It will **not** auto-call anyone.

Click Dial → Phone Link receives number → Your phone's dialler opens → You press Call

SETUP

Setting up Phone Link (one-time, Android + Windows)

If you haven't connected your phone yet, follow these steps once:

1. On your PC, open the **Start menu** and search for **"Phone Link"**. Open it.
2. On your Android phone, install **"Link to Windows"** from the Google Play Store.
3. In Phone Link on your PC, click **Get started**. A QR code appears on screen.
4. Open the Link to Windows app on your phone and **scan the QR code**.
5. Grant **all permissions** when asked – calls, contacts, messages, and notifications.

IMPORTANT

Making calls go to your phone (not your PC speakers)

By default, Phone Link may try to ring through your PC speakers instead of your phone. To make calls go straight to your phone's dialler:

1. Open **Phone Link** on your PC.
2. Click the **Settings gear icon** (top-right corner).
3. Go to **Features**.
4. Under **Calls**, make sure **"Use this PC to make and receive calls"** is turned **ON**.
5. Under the same section, look for the **"Open calls in"** option. Set it to **"Phone"** if available.

> **If calls still ring on your PC:** Open **Phone Link** → **Settings** → **Features** → **Calls** and toggle the calls setting **OFF then ON again**. Then make a test call. If it still routes to your PC, try:
>
> 1. Open **Windows Settings** → **Bluetooth & devices** → **Phone Link**
> 2. Make sure your phone is listed and connected
> 3. Restart both Phone Link on your PC and Link to Windows on your phone

> **Test it:** Open Phone Link, go to the **Calls** tab, and dial any number. If the call rings on your actual phone (not your PC speakers), everything is set up correctly and Ask Dave Real Estate Tools will work the same way.

ALTERNATIVES

If you don't want to use Phone Link

Phone Link is optional. Many agents in Dubai use **WhatsApp for everything** and skip phone calls entirely. If that's you:

- Ignore the Dial button and use the **WhatsApp button** instead
- You can also use the Dial button as a **"Copy number"** action – it copies the number to your clipboard so you can paste it into any other app or dial manually on your phone

iPhone + Windows BETA

Phone Link also works with iPhone via Bluetooth:

1. Turn on **Bluetooth** on your iPhone.
2. Open **Phone Link** on your PC and choose **"iPhone"**.
3. Scan the QR code with your iPhone camera and tap **Pair**.
4. Grant permissions for calls, contacts, and notifications.

Calls go through your iPhone. Keep it within about 10 metres of your PC.

iPhone + Mac BETA

No extra apps needed – Apple handles this natively:

1. Sign into the **same Apple ID** on both devices.
2. Connect both to the **same Wi-Fi network**.
3. On your iPhone: **Settings** → **Phone** → **Calls on Other Devices** → **ON**.
4. Toggle on your Mac in the list below.

Android + Mac BETA

No built-in call routing for this combination. Use **WhatsApp Desktop** for all calls and messages instead.

4. The Expanded Panel – Full Feature View

PANEL

Everything you need in one window

Click **Expand** in the compact window (or click the system tray icon) to open the full expanded panel. This is where all of the app's features live, laid out from top to bottom:

1. **Phone number input** – The detected number appears here. You can also type or paste a number manually. The app normalises it automatically.
2. **Contact card** – Shows editable fields for **name**, **email**, and **unit/property**. These are auto-filled from your highlighted text or can be entered manually.
3. **Action buttons (2×2 grid)** – **Dial**, **WhatsApp**, **Gmail**, and **OneNote**. One click for each action.
4. **Schedule section** – **Book Viewing** and **Book Consultation** buttons that open Google Calendar with event details pre-filled from the contact card.
5. **Follow-up reminders** – **7-day**, **15-day**, and **30-day** buttons. Creates a Google Calendar reminder with the contact's details.
6. **WhatsApp Templates** – 6 message templates. Click one to send it via WhatsApp with placeholders filled in. Click the pencil icon to edit.
7. **Gmail Templates** – 6 email templates. Click one to open Gmail compose with subject and body pre-filled. Click the pencil icon to edit.
8. **OneNote Templates** – 5 role-based templates (Tenant, Landlord, Buyer, Seller, Investor). Creates a structured page in your "Real Estate" notebook with qualifying questions.
9. **Forms (Sales / Rentals / Off-plan tabs)** – RERA contract forms. Send directly via WhatsApp or Gmail.
10. **KYC Forms** – 3 internal compliance forms with a Download (Save As) button. For internal use only.
11. **UAE News Feed** – Live headlines from 12 UAE real estate news sources. Click any headline to read the full article.
12. **Education & Flashcards** – 1,500+ flashcards across 10 decks. Access via the book icon in the panel header. Spaced repetition with mastery tracking.

Using the panel with contact details

Highlight text → Ctrl+Space → Click Expand → Name, email, unit auto-filled → Pick any action

All templates use placeholders – **{name}**, **{number}**, **{email}**, and **{unit}** – which are automatically replaced with the contact's details from the contact card.

5. Message Templates

PANEL

WhatsApp Templates (6 templates)

Ask Dave Real Estate Tools comes with 6 WhatsApp message templates for common real estate situations:

Template	When to use it
Listing Introduction	First contact about a new property
Follow-Up	After a conversation or viewing
Viewing Confirmation	Day before a scheduled viewing
Viewing Reminder	Day of the viewing
New Listing Alert	Notifying a client about a matching property
Thank You	After a viewing or meeting

Gmail Templates (6 templates)

There are also 6 Gmail email templates. Clicking one opens Gmail compose in your browser with the subject line and email body pre-filled. Templates work by opening a `mailto:` link with all the content ready to send.

OneNote Templates (5 role-based templates)

OneNote templates are organised by client role: **Tenant**, **Landlord**, **Buyer**, **Seller**, and **Investor**. Each template creates a structured page in your "Real Estate" OneNote notebook with role-specific qualifying questions pre-filled.

Editing templates

Every template is fully editable. Click the **pencil icon** next to any template to customise the message text. You can modify the wording, add your name and agency, and adjust the tone to match your style.

All templates support these placeholders:

Placeholder	Replaced with
{name}	The contact's name from the contact card
{number}	The contact's phone number
{email}	The contact's email address
{unit}	The property unit or name

> **Tip:** Customise the built-in templates with your actual name and agency. Change the default agent name and agency references to your own. Click the pencil icon on any template to start editing. A yellow ***** indicator appears next to any template you have customised.

6. Additional Features

PANEL

OneNote Integration

Click the **OneNote** button in the action grid, then select a client role (Tenant, Landlord, Buyer, Seller, or Investor). Ask Dave Real Estate Tools creates a structured page in a **"Real Estate"** notebook in your default OneNote notebooks folder, organised into sections by role.

Each page is pre-filled with the contact's details and role-specific qualifying questions – budget range, preferred locations, timeline, and other key information you need to capture during the conversation.

> **Requires:** OneNote desktop application installed on your PC. The integration uses PowerShell COM automation to communicate with OneNote directly.

> **Pro tip – access your notes anywhere:** Install the **OneNote app on your phone** and pin it to your pull-out edge panel or home screen. Your "Real Estate" notebook syncs automatically – so when a client calls, you can pull up their qualifying notes, property interests, and conversation history instantly, wherever you are.

PANEL

Gmail Templates

The 6 Gmail templates open your browser with a Gmail compose window. The subject line and email body are pre-filled with the template content and the contact's details. This works by constructing a `mailto:` link – no Gmail login is needed within the app itself.

If an email address was detected from your highlighted text, it is automatically placed in the "To" field.

PANEL

RERA Forms

The Forms section contains official RERA contract forms organised into three tabs:

- **Sales** – Sale and purchase agreement forms
- **Rentals** – Tenancy contract and rental forms
- **Off-plan** – Off-plan sale and reservation forms

Each form can be sent directly to the client via **WhatsApp** or **Gmail** using the send buttons next to each form.

PANEL

KYC Forms

The KYC Forms section contains 3 internal compliance forms used within your brokerage. These are **download only** – click the **Save As** button to download a copy to your computer. There is no send functionality for KYC forms, as they are meant for internal use.

PANEL

Google Calendar – Book Viewings & Consultations

The Schedule section has two buttons: **Book Viewing** and **Book Consultation**. Clicking either one opens Google Calendar in your browser with a new event pre-filled with the contact's name, phone number, email, and property unit from the contact card.

You choose the date and time in Google Calendar, add any notes, and save. No Google account login is required within the app – it simply opens the calendar URL.

PANEL

Follow-up Reminders

Below the Schedule section, three follow-up buttons let you set reminders:

Button	What it does

7 days	Creates a Google Calendar reminder 7 days from today with the contact's details
15 days	Creates a Google Calendar reminder 15 days from today
30 days	Creates a Google Calendar reminder 30 days from today

Each reminder includes the contact's name, number, and any property details so you have full context when the reminder fires.

PANEL

UAE News Feed

At the bottom of the expanded panel, a live news feed pulls headlines from **12 UAE real estate news sources**. Browse the latest market news, regulatory updates, and industry developments without leaving the app. Click any headline to open the full article in your browser.

7. Education & Flashcards

PANEL

1,500+ flashcards built for Dubai real estate

Click the **book icon** in the panel header to open the Education view. It contains 10 topic decks with over 1,500 flashcards designed specifically for real estate agents in Dubai.

Available decks

Deck	Cards	What it covers
Sales Skills & Scripts	404	Closing techniques, prospecting scripts, NLP, persuasion
Rental & Leasing	235	Tenancy contracts, Ejari, rent cheques, RERA rental index
Property Marketing	181	Listing descriptions, photography, video, portal optimization

Dubai Market Knowledge	131	Dubai 2040, buyer personas, market trends, community insights
Market Analysis	122	CMA methodology, absorption rate, supply-demand, pricing
RERA Exam & Licensing	118	Exam prep, BRN/ORN, compliance, ethics, telemarketing rules
Dealing with Objections	107	Buyer, seller, tenant, and landlord objection scripts
Sales Contracts & Process	101	Form A/B/F, MOU, NOC, DLD transfer, trustee office
Mortgages & Finance	78	LTV ratios, bank processes, eligibility, fees, financing
Property Law & Ownership	40	Freehold vs leasehold, Golden Visa, inheritance, ownership rights

How it works

Each deck uses **spaced repetition** to help you learn efficiently. Cards you struggle with appear more often. Cards you've mastered fade back. After each card, rate your confidence:

- **Again** – show this card more often
- **Good** – show at normal frequency
- **Easy** – show less often

Two card types

- **Flashcards:** Tap to reveal the answer. Rate your confidence.
- **Multiple choice:** Choose from 4 options. The correct answer is highlighted after you pick.

Progress tracking

Each deck shows a progress bar (green = mastered, yellow = learning, red = needs work). An overall mastery ring on the deck selection screen shows your progress across all 1,500+ cards. Your progress is saved locally and persists between sessions.

> **Best for:** New agents preparing for the RERA exam, experienced agents brushing up on property law, or anyone wanting to sharpen their objection handling and closing skills. Study a few cards between calls to build knowledge over time.

8. System Tray & Settings

SYSTEM TRAY

Ask Dave Real Estate Tools lives in your taskbar

Ask Dave Real Estate Tools runs in the background as a system tray icon. It starts automatically when you turn on your computer and stays out of your way until you need it.

Action	What happens
Left-click the tray icon	Opens the compact window
Right-click the tray icon	Shows menu: Open Panel, Settings, Quit
Press `Ctrl+Space`	Detects highlighted text and opens the compact window

Settings

Settings are accessible in two ways: right-click the tray icon and choose **Settings**, or click the **gear icon** in the expanded panel header.

- **Clipboard detection:** Turn on/off automatic phone number detection
- **Hotkey customisation:** Change the `Ctrl+Space` shortcut to a different key combination if needed
- **WhatsApp mode:** Choose between opening WhatsApp in your browser ("Web") or in the WhatsApp Desktop app ("Desktop")

> **Which WhatsApp mode?** If you have WhatsApp Desktop installed, use **"Desktop"** mode – it's faster and opens directly in the app. If you don't want to install it, **"Web"** mode opens wa.me links in your browser which works with WhatsApp Web.

9. Keyboard Shortcuts

WORKS FROM ANY APP

Global shortcut

Ask Dave Real Estate Tools uses one primary keyboard shortcut that works from any application:

Shortcut	Action
`Ctrl+Space`	Detect text from highlighted selection and show the compact window

This works from **any application** – your CRM, browser, Excel, Word, PDFs, emails – anywhere you can highlight text.

> **Customisation:** If `Ctrl+Space` conflicts with another application, you can change the shortcut. Click the **keyboard icon** (Hotkeys button) in the expanded panel header to customise your key combination.

Typical Workflow Examples

Example 1: Quick WhatsApp from CRM

1. You're in your CRM looking at a lead's phone number
2. Highlight the number and press `Ctrl+Space`
3. The compact window appears with the number detected
4. Click **WhatsApp** → pick "Listing Introduction"
5. WhatsApp opens with the message ready – just hit Send

Example 2: Full contact flow from an email signature

1. You receive an email from a prospective buyer. Highlight the entire signature block (name, phone, email, property reference)
2. Press `Ctrl+Space` – the compact window shows the phone number
3. Click **Expand** – the full panel opens with name, email, and unit all auto-filled in the contact card
4. Click **OneNote** → select "Buyer" – a structured page is created with qualifying questions
5. Click **Book Viewing** – Google Calendar opens with the client's details pre-filled
6. Pick a WhatsApp template like "Viewing Confirmation" – the message includes their name and property unit

Example 3: Rapid calling through a list

1. Open your contact list in Excel or your CRM
2. Highlight the first number, press `Ctrl+Space` – compact window appears
3. Click **Dial** – Phone Link opens the number on your phone
4. Make your call, hang up
5. Highlight the next number, press `Ctrl+Space` – compact window updates
6. Click **Dial** again – repeat

Quick Reference

I want to...	Do this
Call someone	Highlight their number → `Ctrl+Space` → click **Dial**
WhatsApp someone	Highlight their number → `Ctrl+Space` → click **WhatsApp**
Send a WhatsApp template	`Ctrl+Space` → Expand → pick a WhatsApp template
Send a Gmail template	`Ctrl+Space` → Expand → pick a Gmail template
Create a OneNote page	`Ctrl+Space` → Expand → click **OneNote** → pick a role
Send a RERA form	`Ctrl+Space` → Expand → Forms → pick form → Send via WhatsApp/Gmail
Download a KYC form	`Ctrl+Space` → Expand → KYC Forms → click **Save As**
Book a viewing	`Ctrl+Space` → Expand → click **Book Viewing**
Set a follow-up reminder	`Ctrl+Space` → Expand → click **7 / 15 / 30 day**
Read UAE news	`Ctrl+Space` → Expand → scroll to **News**
Study flashcards	Click the **book icon** in the panel header → pick a deck → study
Edit a template	Click the **pencil icon** next to any template
Change settings	Click the **gear icon** in the panel header
Customise hotkeys	Click the **keyboard icon** in the panel header
Quit Ask Dave Real Estate Tools	Right-click tray icon → **Quit**

Privacy & Security

- **No data leaves your computer.** Ask Dave Real Estate Tools runs 100% locally. No cloud, no accounts, no tracking.
- **No CRM access.** Ask Dave Real Estate Tools never connects to or reads from your CRM. It only sees text you highlight on screen.

- **Your templates are stored locally** in your user profile. They stay on your machine.
- **No login required.** The app has no authentication, no sign-up, and no user accounts. Your privacy is the default.
- **No hidden costs.** Ask Dave Real Estate Tools is free to use. No subscriptions, no API fees, no trial periods.

Platform Support

Ask Dave Real Estate Tools is currently optimised for **Android + Windows**. The Dial feature works best with Microsoft Phone Link connecting your Android phone to your Windows PC.

macOS and iPhone support are in active development. If you encounter any issues or have feature requests, please reach out via GitHub or email.

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